Atraḫasis MB Flood (The Ark Tablet) | Sources of Early Akkadian Literature

Source: https://seal.huji.ac.il/node/1520 (SEAL – Sources of Early Akkadian Literature, ed. M. P. Streck & N. Wasserman). Retrieved 2026-10-16. Clean extraction of `_raw/node-1520.html`.

Conventions: line numbers exactly as in SEAL (manuscript siglum + column + line; primes = line count from first preserved line). `<sup>…</sup>` = determinatives/superscript signs; subscript digits in sigla rendered as Unicode (C_0). Italics (Akkadian vs. Sumerogram distinction) are NOT preserved here – see the raw HTML. Under each line, `lemmas:` lists SEAL's lemmatisation (lemma + gloss) for that line.

Metadata

- **Texts Hierarchy:** Projects;SEAL;Epics and Myths;Middle Babylonian/Assyrian;Atraḫasis
- **Images:** Ark Tablet obv. (British Museum); Ark Tablet rev. (British Museum); Wasserman 2020a 63; Wasserman 2020a 64; Wasserman 2020a 65; Wasserman 2020a 65
- **Copy / Photo:** Wasserman 2020a; 63–65; Finkel 2014; after p. 150; Finkel 2014; 107, 109
- **Measurements:** circumference; 11.2 x 6.2 x 2.5; cm
- **Collection:** Douglas Simmonds Collection
- **Edition:** Wasserman 2020a; 66–70; Finkel 2014; 357–368
- **Studies:** Finkel 2014
- **Genre / Classification:** Epics, Atraḫasis
- **Provenance:** Unknown
- **Notes:** Ms. Ark
- **Revision History:** Wasserman, Nathan; Cataloguing; Streck, Michael P.; Images; 15/05/19; Tulaikova, Yulia; Indexing; 02/09/21

Text (transliteration)

Obv.

Ark 1 i-ga-ar i-ga-a[r k]i-ki-iš ki-ki-iš
lemmas: igāru I “wall”; igāru I “wall”; kikkišu I “reed fence, wall”; kikkišu I “reed fence, wall”
Ark 2 ^mAt-ra-am-ḫa-si-i[s] a-na mi-il-ki-ia qú-ul-[ma]
lemmas: Atra-hasis I; ana I “to, for”; milku I “advice, counsel; resolution, intelligence”; qâlu I “to pay attention; be silent”
Ark 3 ta-ba-al-lu-uṭ [d]a-ri-iš
lemmas: balāṭu II “to live”; dāriš I “for ever”

Ark 4 ú-pu-ud bītam(É) bi-ni eleppam(MÁ) m[a-a]k-ku-ra-am ze-e[r-ma]
lemmas: napādu II “to separate, cut off”; bītu I “house”; banû IV “to create; build”; eleppu I “ship, boat”; makkūru I “property, possession(s)”; zêru I “to dislike, hate; reject”
Ark 5 na-pí-iš-tam šu-ul-lim
lemmas: napištu I “throat, life”; šalāmu II “to be(come) healthy, intact”
Ark 6 eleppam(MÁ) te-ep-pu-šu e-[ṣ]e-er-ši-ma
lemmas: eleppu I “ship, boat”; epēšu II “to do; make; build”; eṣēru I “to draw, design”
Ark 7 e-ṣe-er-ti ki-[i]p-pa-tim
lemmas: uṣurtu I “drawing, plan”; kippatu I “circle, hoop, ring”
Ark 8 lu mi-it-ḫa-ar ši-id-da-[š]a ù pu-u[s-sa]
lemmas: lū I “let it be”; mahāru I “to face, confront; oppose; receive”; šiddu I “side, edge; curtain”; u I “and, but, also”; pūtu I “forehead, brow”
Ark 9 lu-ú 1 ikû(IKU) ka-aq-qá-ar-š[a lu]-⌈ú⌉ 1 nindanum(NINDA) i-ga-r[a-tu-ša]
lemmas: lū I “let it be”; ištēn I “one”; ikû I “field”; qaqqaru I “ground, earth”; lū I “let it be”; ištēn I “one”; nindanu I “rod, pole”; igāru I “wall”
Ark 10 ka-an-nu aš-la-a <lu> ṭá-mu-⌈ú⌉ [a-na libbi(ŠÀ)]-ša
lemmas: kannu II “band, binding”; ašlu I “rush; rope”; lū I “let it be”; ṭawû I “to spin, plait”; ana I “to, for”; libbu I “inner body; heart”
Ark 11 li-ip-ti-il-kum bītī(É^{bi}^{-ti}) pí-[t]i-il-tam
lemmas: patālu I “to twine”; bītu I “house”; pitiltu I “string, cord”
Ark 12 ŠÁR (x) 4 (+) 30 ta-qab-bi-am li-[ku]-ul
lemmas: šār I “3,600”; qabû II “to say, speak, command”; akālu I “to eat”
Ark 13 30 ṣe-ri i-na libbi(ŠÀ)-ša a[d]-di
lemmas: šalāšā I “thirty”; ṣēlu I “rib”; ina I “in, on; by; from”; libbu I “inner body; heart”; nadû III “to throw (down); lay down”
Ark 14 ša 1 parsiktum(PI) ik-bi-ru 10 nindanum(NINDA) mu-⌈ra⌉-ak-šu
lemmas: ša I “who(m), which; (s)he who, that which; of”; ištēn I “one”; parsiktu I “bushel measure”; kabāru I “to be(come) thick, solid”; ešer I “ten”; nindanu I “rod, pole”; mūraku I “length”
Ark 15 ŠÁR im-di i-na libbi(ŠÀ)-ša ú-ki-in
lemmas: šār I “3,600”; imdu I “support”; ina I “in, on; by; from”; libbu I “inner body; heart”; kânu I “to be(come) permanent, firm, true”
Ark 16 ša ½ <parsiktum(PI)> ik-bi-ru-ma ½ nindanum(NINDA) mu-⌈ra⌉-ak-šu
lemmas: ša I “who(m), which; (s)he who, that which; of”; parsiktu I “bushel measure”; kabāru I “to be(come) thick, solid”; nindanu I “rod, pole”; mūraku I “length”
Ark 17 ar-ku-ús ḫi-in-ni-ša◦ e-le-nu-um ⌈ù⌉ ša-ap-lu◦-um
lemmas: rakāsu I “to bind”; hinnu I “ship's cabin”; elēnu I “above, over”; u I “and, but, also”; šaplu II “underside, bottom”
Ark 18 1 šu-ši iṭṭâm(ESIR) ki◦-da-ti-ša ap-[r]u-ús
lemmas: ištēn I “one”; šūši I “sixty”; iṭṭû I “bitumen”; kīdītu I “exterior part”; parāsu I “to cut (off);

decide″
Ark 19 1 šu-ši iṭṭâm(ESIR) qí-ri-ib-ša ⌈ap⌉-[r]u-ús
lemmas: ištēn I “one”; šūši I “sixty”; iṭṭû I “bitumen”; qerbu II “centre, interior”; parāsu I “to cut (off); decide″
Ark 20 1 šu-ši iṭṭâm(ESIR) a-na ḫi-in-ni-ša aš-[t]a-pa-ak
lemmas: ištēn I “one”; šūši I “sixty”; iṭṭû I “bitumen”; ana I “to, for”; hinnu I “ship's cabin”; šapāku I “to heap up; pour on″
Ark 21 uš-ta-ar-ki-ib ŠÁR (x) 8? kupram(⌈ESIR.UD.DU.A⌉) [i-n]a ⌈ki⌉-<ra>-ti-ia
lemmas: rakābu I “to ride”; šār I “3,600”; kupru I “bitumen, pitch”; ina I “in, on; by; from”; kīru I “oven, kiln″
Ark 22 ù ŠÁR iṭṭâm(ESIR) a-na li-ib-bi aš-pu-uk
lemmas: u I “and, but, also”; šār I “3,600”; iṭṭû I “bitumen”; ana I “to, for”; libbu I “inner body; heart”; šapāku I “to heap up; pour on″
Ark 23 iṭṭûm(ESIR) ú!-ul iq-r[i]-ba-am-ma
lemmas: iṭṭû I “bitumen”; ul I “not”; qerēbu I “to be/come close″
Ark 24 5 šu-ši na-⌈ḫa⌉-[a]m ú-⌈re⌉-[e]d-di
lemmas: šūši I “sixty”; nāhu I “pig's fat, lard”; redû I “to accompany, lead, drive, proceed″
Ark 25 uš-⌈ta-ar⌉-[k]i-ib ⌈ki⌉-ra-ti-⌈ia⌉ mi-it-ḫa-ri-iš
lemmas: rakābu I “to ride”; kīru I “oven, kiln”; mithāriš I “in the same manner″
Ark 26 bīnam(^{gi}[^š]⌈ŠINIG⌉) ⌈^{giš}⌉x-i
lemmas: bīnu II “tamarisk″
Ark 27 x x x e? na? as tum i? bi? ma? ba-⌈ar⌉-tam

Lo. Ed.

Ark 28 x x x (x)^{meš}? x [x x x]
Ark 29 i-⌈il⌉-la-ku bi-⌈rit?⌉ ṣe-⌈x⌉-[x-x]
lemmas: alāku I “to go”; birīt I “between, among″
Ark 30 [x x] x nam-mi [x] x x [x x]
Ark 31 [. . . ki?-ra?-ti?]-ia i-x [x x] ki ESIR.⌈UD?.DU?⌉
lemmas: kīru I “oven, kiln”; kupru I “bitumen, pitch″

Rev.

Ark 32 kupru(⌈ESIR.UD.DU⌉) ki-du-⌈ú⌉ [ša k]i-ra-ti x x x
lemmas: kupru I “bitumen, pitch”; kīdû I “exterior”; ša I “who(m), which; (s)he who, that which; of”; kīru I “oven, kiln″
Ark 33 e-zu-ub 2 (× 60) kur(G[UR]) ⌈ú-pa-az-zi⌉-<ru°> um-mi-⌈a⌉-⌈nu⌉
lemmas: ezib I “except (that)”; kurru I “(measure of dry capacity)”; pazāru I “to hide o.s., be hidden”; ummiānu I “craftsman″
Ark 34 ⌈uš⌉-ta-na-⌈al⌉-[la?-ak?-šu?-nu?-ti? i?-n]a? ri-a-ši

lemmas: alāku I “to go”; ina I “in, on; by; from”; riāšu I “to rejoice”

Ark 35 a-na eleppi(MÁ) ⌈i⌉-[ru-bu-ma] x x k[i-i]m? ⌈sa⌉-al-la-at

lemmas: ana I “to, for”; eleppu I “ship, boat”; erēbu I “to enter”; kīmu I “family”; salātu I “family, clan”

Ark 36 ŋa-du-ú ⌈x⌉ [x x x] ⌈ki?⌉ [x x] x e-mu-tim

lemmas: hadû I “joyful”; emūtu I “relatives by marriage; marriage relationship”

Ark 37 ù za-bi-il ⌈x?⌉ [x x x] ⌈x x x⌉ ⌈e⌉-ri-ia°-⌈tum⌉

lemmas: u I “and, but, also”; zabbilu I “(used to) bearing; bearer”; arītu I “pregnant (woman)”

Ark 38 a-ki-lum i-⌈ik⌉-k[a-a]l [ša-tu-um] i-ša-at-ti

lemmas: akālu I “to eat”; akālu I “to eat”; šatû II “to drink”; šatû II “to drink”

Ark 39 a-na-ku a-wa-⌈tum⌉ ⌈i⌉-[na] [lib]bi([Š]À)-i[a] i-ba-aš-ši-ma

lemmas: anāku I “I; me”; awātu I “word; matter”; ina I “in, on; by; from”; libbu I “inner body; heart”; bašû I “to be (at hand, available); exist”

Ark 40 ta°-na-ti ⌈a°?⌉-[x x x l]i-ib-bi

lemmas: tanittu I “(hymn of) praise”; libbu I “inner body; heart”

Ark 41 ša°-ap-[tu?] -ú -a

lemmas: šaptu I “lip; rim”

Ark 42 bi-ni-it? x x [. . .] . . . i?-⌈na°⌉-ia°

lemmas: binītu I “creation; shape, appearance, structure”; īnu I “eye”

Ark 43 ⌈ù°⌉ áš°-⌈gi°⌉-⌈iš°⌉ . . . [. . .] e? ša-ap-ti-ia

lemmas: u I “and, but, also”; šagāšu I “to kill, slaughter”; šaptu I “lip; rim”

Ark 44 [x x]-ne? ⌈ra⌉-bi-⌈iš⌉ ⌈x⌉ [x x x]-ma° ši°-ib!?(Text:BI)-qum aṣ-la-al

lemmas: rabîš I “greatly”; šibqū I “scheme, plan; trick, plot”; ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep”

Ark 45 [e-li] a-na ú-ri ⌈ú⌉-[sa-ap-pi(?) a]-⌈na⌉ ^dEN.ZU be-li

lemmas: elû III “to go up, arise; (stat.) is high”; ana I “to, for”; ūru I “roof”; suppû II “to pray”; ana I “to, for”; Sin I; bēlu I “lord; proprietor (of)”

Ark 46 ⌈x x x⌉ li-ib-bi? [ta?-ta?-a]b-ba-al

lemmas: libbu I “inner body; heart”; tabālu I “to take away, carry off”

Ark 47 x x ri x ak? [x x x x] x ti?-bi ik-la

lemmas: iklu I “darkness”

Ark 48 ⌈i⌉-na ⌈li?°⌉-[ib?-bi?]-ia

lemmas: ina I “in, on; by; from”; libbu I “inner body; heart”

Ark 49 ^dEN.LÍL° i-na kussî(⌈^{giš}⌉⌈GU⌉.⌈ZA⌉)-⌈šu⌉ [it-ta-m]e ga-ma-ar-tam

lemmas: Ellil I “Enlil”; ina I “in, on; by; from”; kussû I “chair, stool, throne”; tamû II “to swear”; gamertu I “completeness; destruction”

Ark 50 ⌈ù⌉ ar-m[u-tam i-na u_4-mi-im] ⌈e-ṭi⌉-i[m (x x x)]

lemmas: u I “and, but, also”; armūtu I “desolation”; ina I “in, on; by; from”; ūmu I “day”; eṭû I “dark”

Ark 51 ù na-ma-aš-t[um i-na ṣe]-ri-i[m (. . .)]

lemmas: u I “and, but, also”; nammaštû I “moving things, animals”; ina I “in, on; by; from”; ṣēru I “back, upperside; steppe, open country”
Ark 52 ⌈ša⌉-na eleppa(MÁ) ⌈lu?⌉-[ú x x x x] x x x [x x x x]
lemmas: šanā I “two each, two by two”; eleppu I “ship, boat”; lū I “let it be”
Ark 53 5 šikara(KAŠ) ar-m]a?[x x uš-t[a-x x x x]
lemmas: šikaru I “beer; alcoholic drink”
Ark 54 11 ù!° 12 ⌈ú⌉-za-ab-ba-⌈lu⌉ x (x) [x x x]
lemmas: u I “and, but, also”; zabālu I “to carry, deliver”
Ark 55 3 ^úši-iq-bi u[k?-ta-x x] x x x x
lemmas: šiqbu I “(a kind of plant)”
Ark 56 1/3 ú-ku-lu-ú [x-x]-⌈mu?/gu?⌉ [kur?]-din?-⌈nu⌉
lemmas: ukullû I “provisions, fodder”; kurdinnu I “(an evil-smelling plant)”
Ark 57 1 šu-ši na-ḫa-am a-na ⌈gi-ri⌉-ma-de-e ⌈aq?-ta?⌉-[na?-bi?]
lemmas: šūši I “sixty”; nāhu I “pig's fat, lard”; ana I “to, for”; germadû I “floor timbers (of ship), poles for the slipway”; qabû II “to say, speak, command”
Ark 58 e-zu-ub 30 kur(GUR) ú-pa!?-az-zi-ru° ^{lú!(BI°).meš}um-mi-⌈a⌉-[nu]
lemmas: ezib I “except (that)”; kurru I “(measure of dry capacity)”; pazāru I “to hide o.s., be hidden”; ummiānu I “craftsman”

Up. Ed.

Ark 59 ⌈i⌉-nu-ma a-na-ku e-ru-bu-ma
lemmas: inūma I “when”; anāku I “I; me”; erēbu I “to enter”
Ark 60 pi-ḫi pít ba-bi-⌈ša⌉
lemmas: pehû II “to close up, seal”; pītu I “opening, aperture”; bābu I “gate, door”

Translation

Obv.

Ark 1 “Wall, wall! Reed fence, reed fence!

Ark 2–3 Atra-ḫasīs, pay attention to my advice, so that you live forever!

Ark 4–5 Depart from (your) house, build a boat! Spurn property [and] keep (your) life intact!

Ark 6–7 The boat which you will build, I will draw it out (for you) – a circular plan:

Ark 8–9 Her length and breadth should be equal, her base should be one ikû; her hull (lit. walls) should be one nindanu (high).

Ark 10 [Let] the cords – each ašlu long – be woven [inside(?)] it.

Ark 11–12 Should you say: ‘(But) this will consume 14,430 (qû of fiber)!’ – Let my temple (personnel) twist the fibers into a rope for you”.

Ark 13–14 I put up thirty ribs which are one parsiktu-vessel thick, ten nindanu long.

Ark 15–16 I have installed 3,600 stanchions in it which are half (a parsiktu-vessel) thick, half a nindanu long.

Ark 17 I arranged her cabins above and below.

Ark 18–19 I allocated sixty (kors) of crude bitumen for her outsides, I allocated sixty (kors) of crude bitumen for her interior.

Ark 20 I have poured sixty (kors) of crude bitumen onto her cabins.

Ark 21–22 I loaded my kilns with 28,800 (qû) of dry bitumen, I poured (additional) 3,600 (qû) of crude bitumen within –

Ark 23–24 (yet) the bitumen did not reach (the required amount), (so) I set out 300 (qû) of lard.

Ark 25–26 I loaded [my] kilns evenly with tamarisk wood(?) and . . . a wood of (?).

Ark 27 … …

Lo. Ed.

Ark 28 … … …

Ark 29 They are going between …

Ark 30 … … …

Ark 31 […] my [kilns(?)] … dry(?) bitumen …

Rev.

Ark 32–33 [I applied(?)] on the outside the dry bitumen [from the k]ilns, apart from the 120 kors which the workmen had cached.

Ark 34–35 Ordering [them] to go joyfully, (my) kith and kin [entered into] the boat . . .;

Ark 36–37 Happy . . . [. . .] . . . of my in-laws and the bearer(s) of [. . .] and the pregnant (women).

Ark 38 The one (who wanted) to eat was eating; [the one (who wanted) to drink] was drinking,

Ark 39–40 I, however, there was a (heavy) thought in my heart, and I have … the praises(?). . . [. . .] (my?) heart.

Ark 41–42 My li[p]s(?), the creation(?) . . . [. . .] of my eyes,

Ark 43 and I slaughter[ed (animals)] . . . of my lips.

Ark 44–45 [I was] greatly [worried as] the plan(?) was […]; I lied down. I went up on the roof and [prayed(?)] to Sîn, my lord:

Ark 46 “Remove(?) the… of my heart!”

Ark 47–48 . . . . . darkness(?) into my he[art].

Ark 49–40 Enlil, from [his thr]one, [took an oath (?)] regarding the annihilation and de[solation(?) on the] dimming [day].

Ark 51–52 And so, wild anima[ls from the s]teppe [(. . .)], two by two, [I] did [make enter] into the boat . . . [. . .].

Ark 53–54 I had . . . five (measures) of beer . . . [. . .]. They were transporting eleven or twelve [. . .].

Ark 55–56 Three (measures) of šiqbum-plant . . [. . .], one-third (measure) of fodder, . . . and kurdinnu-plant(?),

Ark 57–58 sixty (qû) of lard for the germadû-poles for the slipway – I meticulously commanded (to bring), apart from the thirty kors which the workmen had put aside.

Ark 59–60 When I have entered the boat, (I ordered:) “Caulk the frame of her door!”